

Selection Tools

Learning Objectives

- Use rectangle, ellipse, and free select tools
- Understand when to use each selection type
- Practice selecting and modifying portions of an image

Engage (5-7 minutes)

When a tailor cuts cloth, they first draw the outline of the piece they need. Selection tools in GIMP are like that tailor's chalk—they let you mark exactly which part of the image you want to change, move, or delete. Today we learn to outline the parts we want to work with.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open a sample image in GIMP. Try the Rectangle Select tool—drag a box around part of the image. Then try the Ellipse Select tool for a circular selection. Finally, try the Free Select (lasso) tool to draw a custom shape. Copy and paste each selection to see the result.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Selection tools define which area of an image you want to edit. Rectangle Select creates square or rectangular selections. Ellipse Select creates circular or oval selections. Free Select (Lasso) lets you draw any shape by hand. After selecting, you can cut, copy, fill, or apply effects only to the selected area.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Think of drawing a boundary around a field for planting crops. The rectangle is like a paddy field, the ellipse is like a circular garden bed, and the free select is like an irregular plot along a riverbank. Each shape suits different needs. Which selection tool would you use to isolate a person's face from a group photo?

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Name three selection tools and give one use case for each. Then select a portion of an image and change its color. If you finish early, practice using the feather option to soften selection edges.